FREE GUIDE · VA AT AI EP 3

AI Automation VA: Starter Projects

You build systems that do the repeated work. Practise in your own accounts first.

Word	Meaning	Example
Trigger	What starts the automation	Someone fills out a form
Action	What happens next	Save to CRM, send an email
Condition	A yes or no check	Only if the budget is over $1,000
AI step	AI writes, summarises or sorts	Draft a personal reply

Tool	Best for	Note
Zapier	Beginners, quick connections	Has a free plan to learn
Make	Visual, multi-step scenarios	Good value for bigger flows
n8n	AI agents, technical flows	Can be self-hosted
GoHighLevel	Agency clients, CRM and follow-ups	Workflows plus AI features

Before you turn an automation on

☐ Test with dummy data, never real customers first
☐ Add an approval step for important messages
☐ Check what happens if a field is empty
☐ Write a short SOP with screenshots
☐ Tell the client what it does and how to pause it

5 STARTER PROJECTS · VA AT AI EP 3

Build these for your portfolio

Each one is small, useful and easy to show in a Loom video.

Project	Trigger	Actions and AI step
1. Form to sheet	New Google Form response	Add a row to Google Sheets, send a thank-you email
2. New lead reply	Website or Facebook lead form	Save to CRM with a tag, AI drafts a personal reply, notify the client
3. Inbox sorter	New email	AI labels it (lead, support, invoice), urgent ones go to Slack
4. Meeting follow-up	Meeting notes added to a folder	AI writes a summary and action items, sends a draft email for approval
5. Weekly report	Every Friday	Pull numbers from a sheet, AI writes 3 insights, email the report

HOW TO DESCRIBE IT IN YOUR PORTFOLIO

I built an automation that replies to new leads in under 1 minute. It saves the lead in the CRM, drafts a personal reply with AI, and notifies the owner. Every AI reply is checked by an approval step.